

EVIDENCE · CANVAS · SERIES

bar

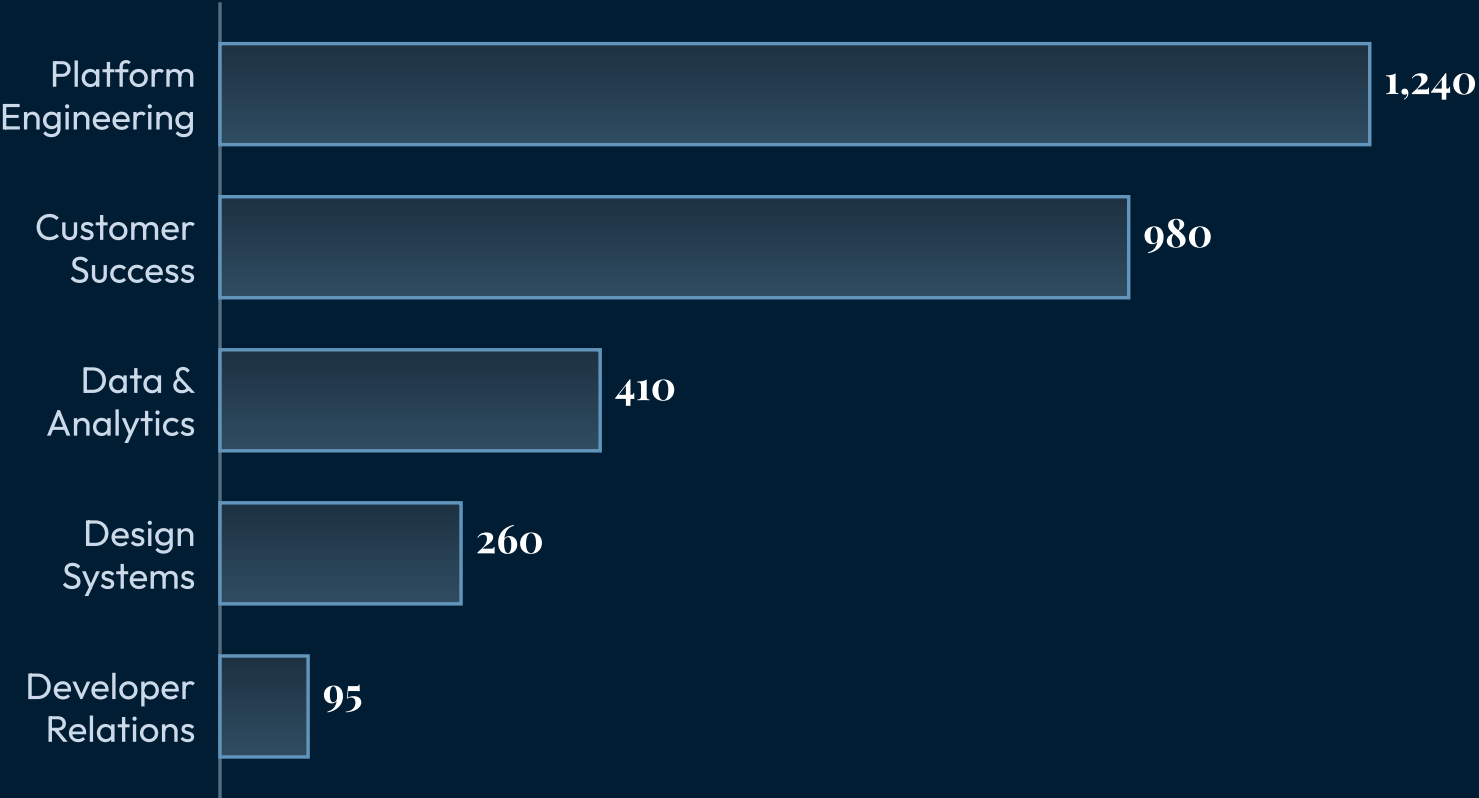
Bars from a zero baseline that compare magnitude across categories — as columns, rows, side-by-side groups, or signed off a centered zero.

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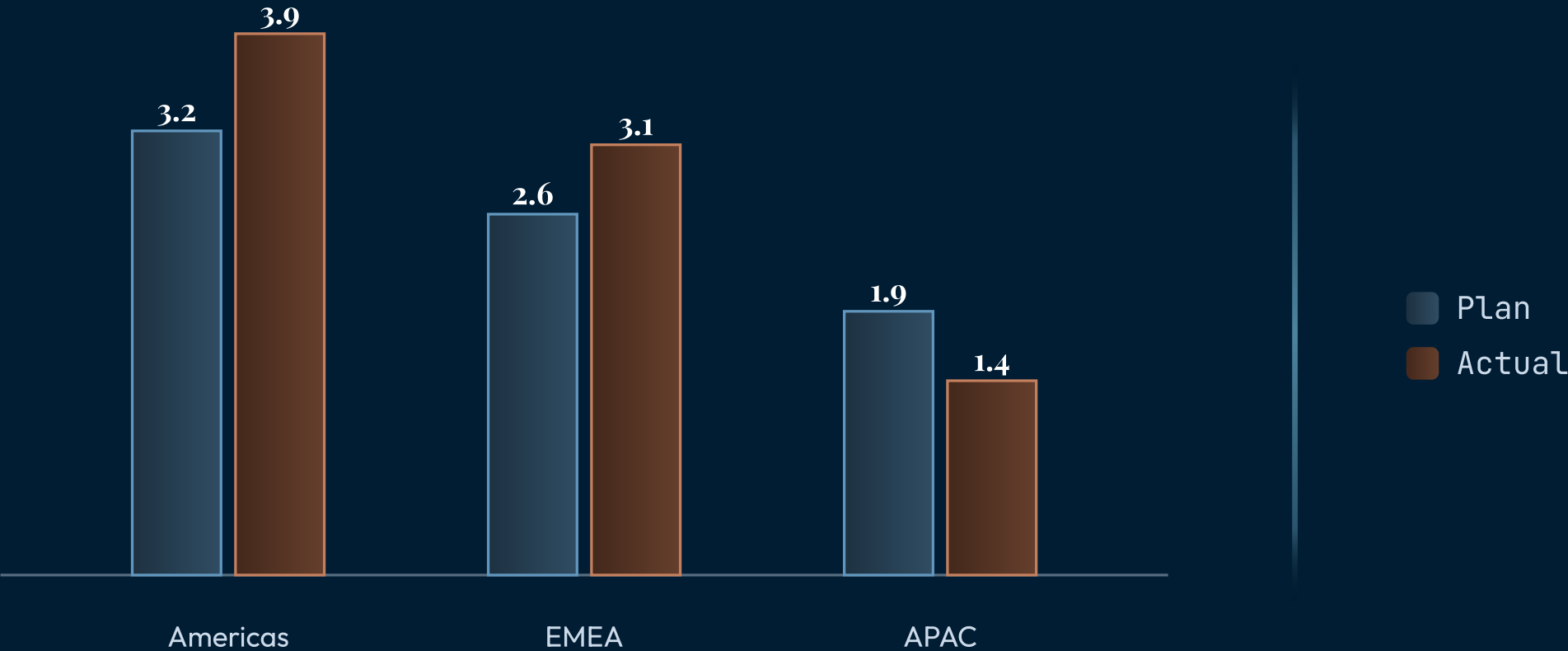
Growth is concentrated in two regions.



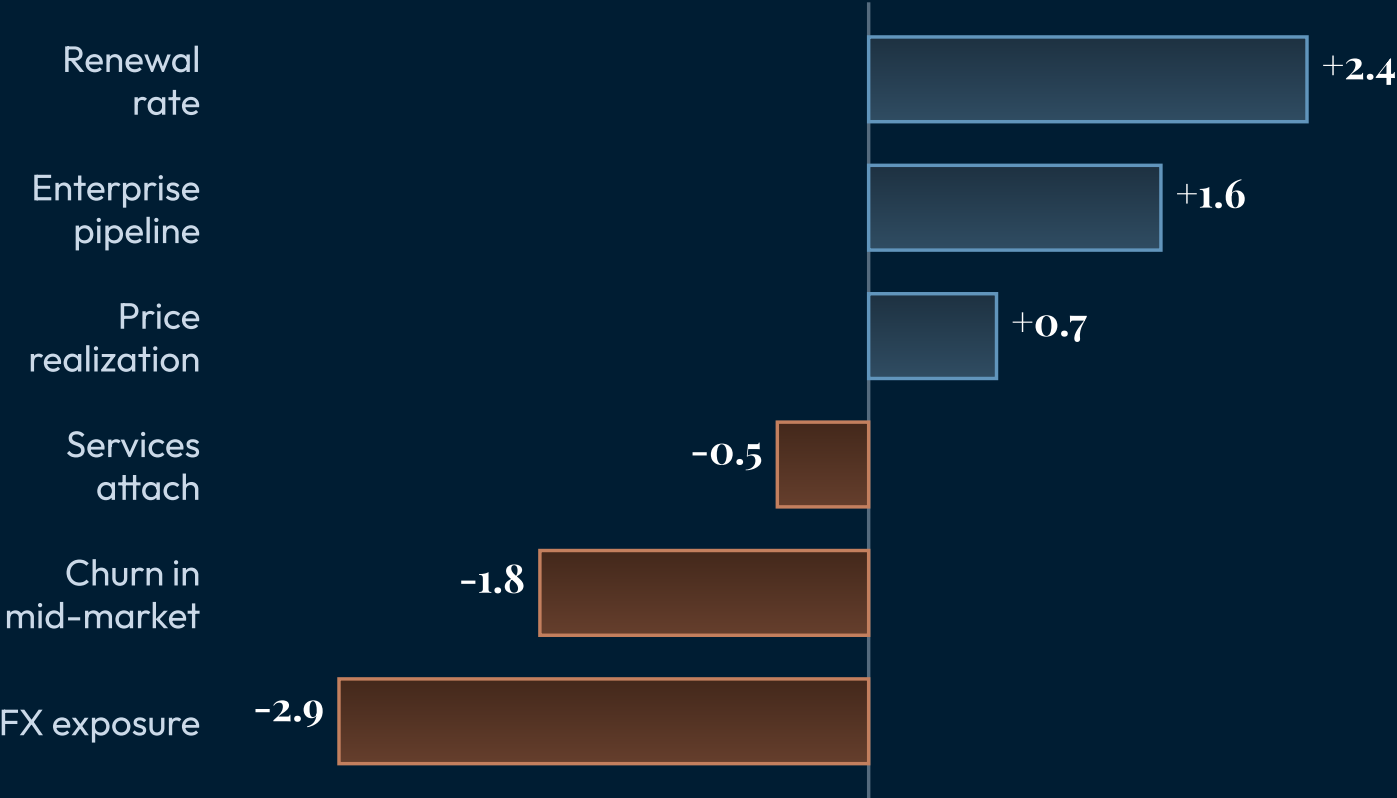
Support load sits with two teams.



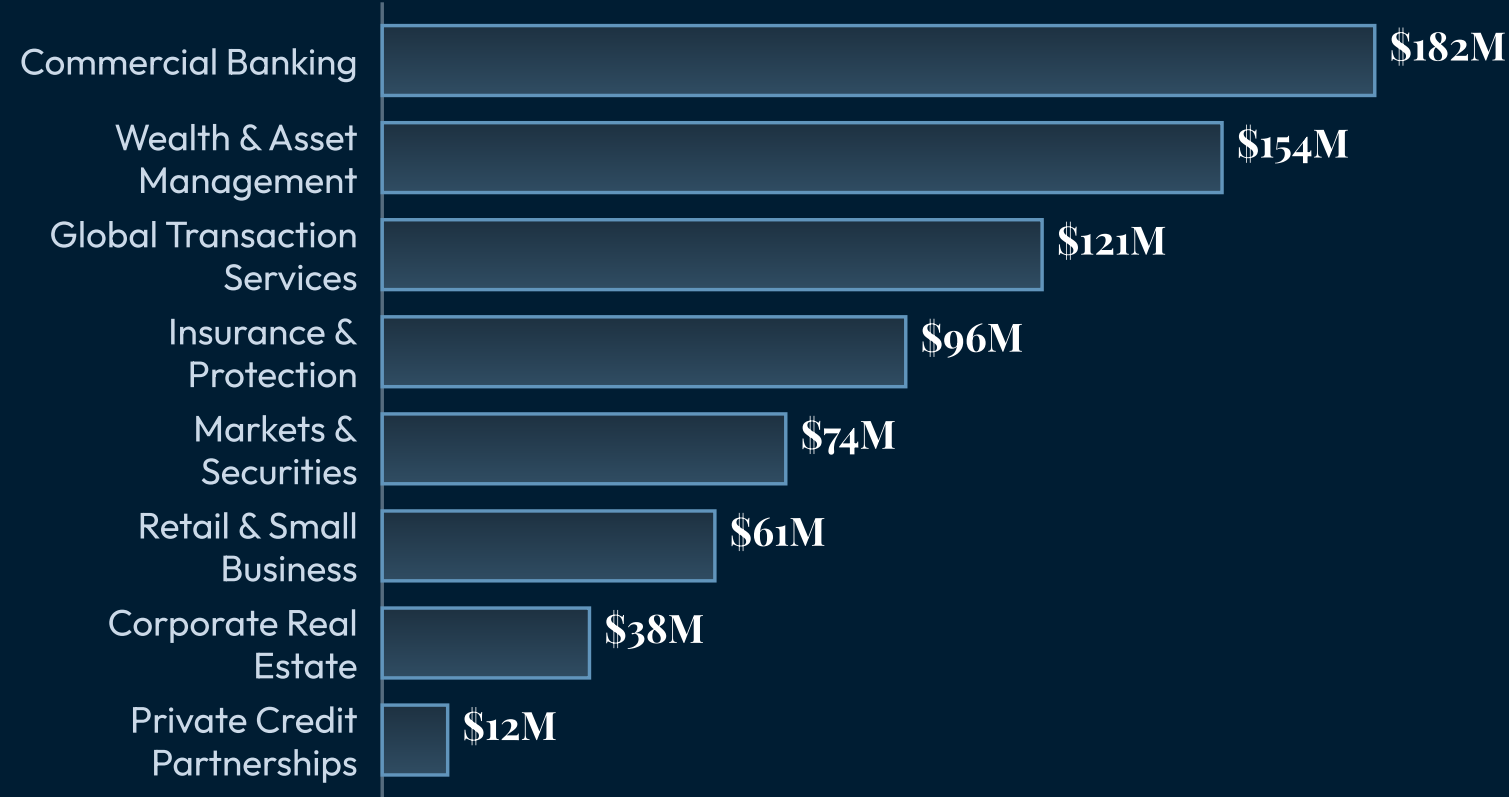
We beat plan everywhere but APAC.



What moves the forecast, and which way.



Every unit named in full, nothing abbreviated.



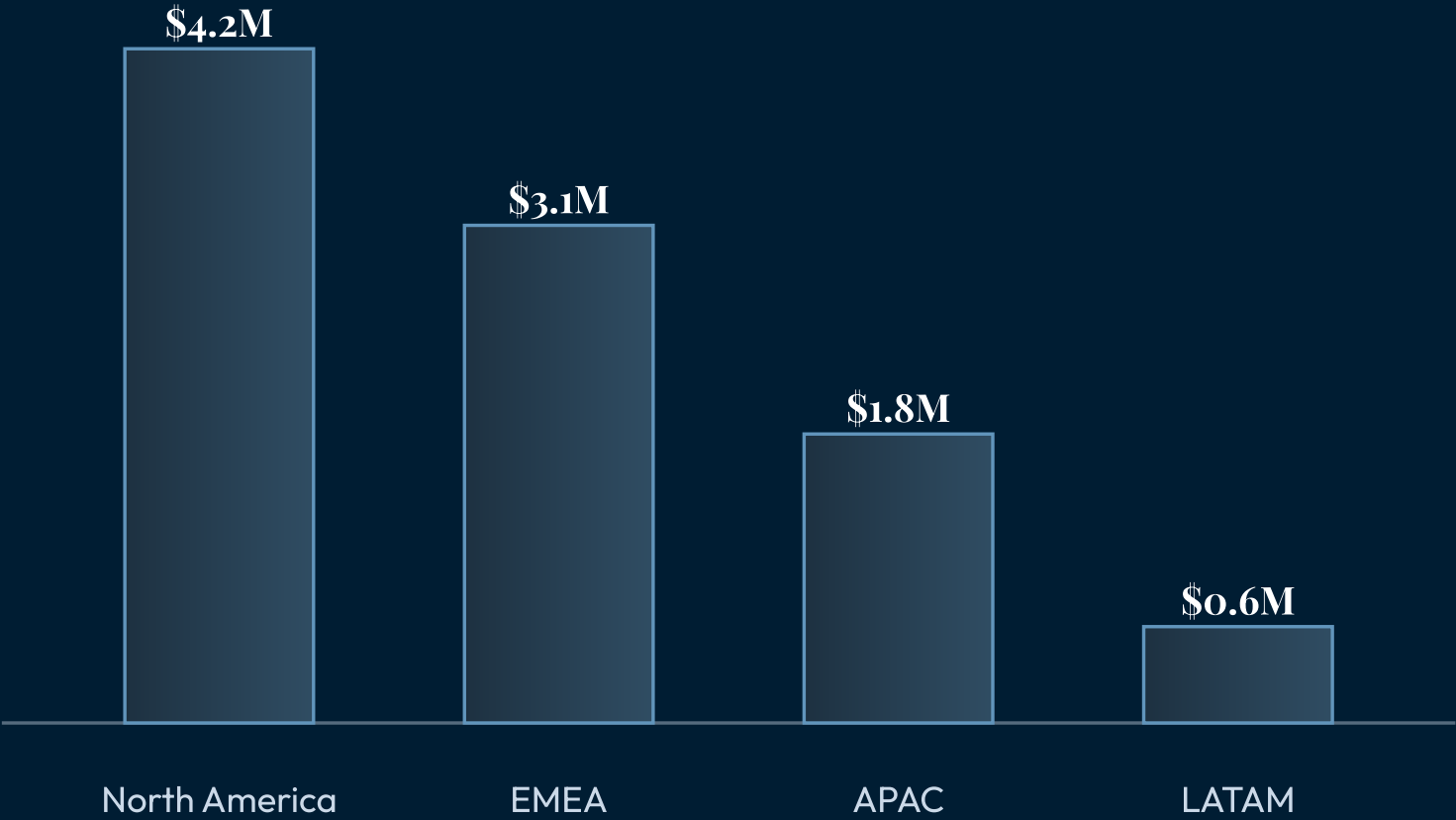
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When NOT to reach for bar.

Parts of one whole

If the categories add up to a meaningful total and the story is the split, use `piechart` (one whole) or the `stacked-bar` sibling (a total that decomposes across categories). A plain bar deliberately says nothing about a sum.

A continuous series over time

Twelve monthly bars ask the reader to compare twelve lengths when the claim is a trend. Use the `line` sibling — its whole job is the shape of the movement. Bars are for a handful of named categories, not a time series.

A percentage against a target

'68% of goal' is attainment, not magnitude across categories. `progress` shows attainment; `bullet` adds the target and the qualitative band. A bar chart of percentages that do not compare to each other is a table with decoration.

A rainbow single series

Do not reach for a per-category color. A single series is one hue here by design: the length already carries the whole comparison, and a second encoding that says nothing is the classic amateur tell. Color earns its place only in `grouped`, where it names the series.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`progress` — attainment against 100% rather than magnitude
against each other

`piechart` — parts of a single whole, where the shares sum to
one total

`funnel` — each stage is a subset of the one before and the
drop-off is the story

`stats` — a row of headline figures with no like-for-like
comparison between them

`big-number` — one figure is the whole slide